

Section 2. General aspects of importation

2.1 Introduction

From a customs perspective, the most important aspect in relation to the importation of goods is that they are declared to customs on arrival in Ireland. How this is done, and the type of declaration required will depend on the circumstances in each case.

2.2 Economic Operator Registration and Identification (EORI) number (Article 9 UCC)

EORI is a system which allocates a unique reference number to every trader who interacts with Customs Authorities in any Member State of the EU. This reference number will be valid throughout the EU and will serve as a common reference for the trader's interaction with the Customs Authorities of any Member State. It may also be used for the exchange of information between the Customs Authorities of other member states within the EU, and where appropriate, between Customs and other authorities e.g. statistical authorities.

An economic operator is obliged to register for a EORI. In this regard, traders should be advised strongly to apply for an EORI number before the filing of their first declaration.

The EORI application process differs according to whether an economic operator is established within or outside the customs territory of the Union:

- (i) An economic operator established in the customs territory of the Union must apply for an EORI number to the Customs Authority of the Member State in which the economic operator is established.
- (ii) An economic operator not established in the customs territory of the Union must apply for an EORI number to the Customs Authority of the Member State where the economic operator will first lodge an entry summary declaration or where they apply for a Customs Decision.

In Ireland, E-Customs and Risk Management Branch, Customs Division deal with the allocation of EORI numbers. Requests for clarification/advice on EORI matters can be directed to them at the following:

E-mail address: ecustoms@revenue.ie

Helpdesk: + 353 1 738 3677

Further information on EORI can be found on the [Revenue website](#). An eLearning tool is available to download from the [European Commission website](#). 